ESL Brains

Present Perfect activities

EXERCISE 1: PRESENT PERFECT (JUST, ALREADY, YET)

Complete the sentences using Present Perfect and *already*, *just* or *yet*.

EXAMPLE: I wrote an email to my boss yesterday, but *I haven't sent it **yet***.

I wrote an email to my boss yesterday, so *she's **already** read the report.*

I wrote an email to my boss yesterday and *she has **just** replied.*

A. Sarah made a delicious lemon cake, but _____

Sarah made a delicious lemon cake and _____

B. I have to buy a present for my friend, but _____

I have to buy a present for my friend, so _____

C. Rafa graduated from high school, but _____

Rafa graduated from high school and _____

D. My dog wants to go for a walk, but _____

My dog wants to go for a walk and _____

E. I know I need to see my doctor, so _____

I know I need to see my doctor and _____

F. My parents would love to see Paris, but _____

My parents would love to see Paris, so _____

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EXERCISE 2: PRESENT PERFECT (ALREADY, YET)

Look at the photos and say <u>at least two</u> things that have (already) happened and <u>at least two</u> things that haven't happened yet.

EXAMPLE: The friends are having lunch together.

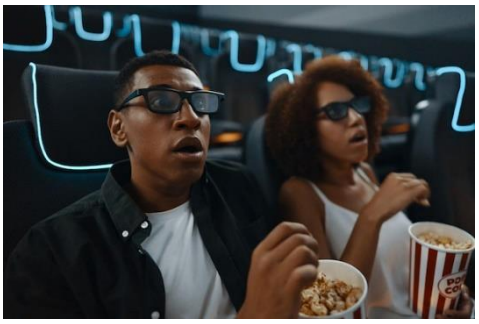
They've already ordered their food. The waiter has already brought their food. They've already taken a picture of the food.

They haven't posted the picture on social media yet. They haven't eaten and they haven't paid yet.





A. She's going to work.



B. They're watching a 3D film.



C. He wants to make lunch.



D. They're having a party for 20 people.



E. He's going to visit his family.



F. Her daughter asked her to paint her a picture.

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EXERCISE 3: PRESENT PERFECT (TELLING THE NEWS)

Read the details (A–C) and say which piece of news (1–6) they are about.

A. We've worked really hard, and it has finally happened. Now, we can get a pet, have parties and grow our own food in the garden.

B. She's been married for four years. She's really happy because it's been her dream. She's taken some time off, but she's planning to go back to work when she finds a good babysitter.

C. I've just received an email from the company about it. I'm excited about new responsibilities because I've always wanted to try to manage a team.

1. My cousin's had a baby!
2. My team and I have successfully finished a big project!
3. I've got promoted!
4. My neighbour has got a dog!
5. I've started a business!
6. My partner and I have bought a house!

Read the details and guess the news using Present Perfect.

- My mother has studied and practised a lot. She's never had a car, but now she's saving to buy one.

You will receive a card with a piece of news. Provide some details about it for your partner to guess your news. Don't make it too easy to guess. Use at least two structures with Present Perfect.

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EXERCISE 4: PRESENT PERFECT (TALKING ABOUT EXPERIENCES)

You are going to receive cards from your teacher. Work in pairs. Take turns reading a statement on a card and doing the tasks below.

A. Say two sentences to your partner connected with the situation using Present Perfect: one negative with *never* and one positive.

B. Ask your partner a question connected to the topic, but not the same as the statement on your card.

EXAMPLES:

I have never had a car.	My friend has never sung karaoke.
I have never bought petrol.	*She/He has never been to a karaoke bar.*
I have had a bike.	*She/He has always wanted to try it.*
Have you taken a driving test?	*Have any of your friends been to a karaoke bar?*
Have you ever had a bike?	*Have any of your friends participated in a music competition?*

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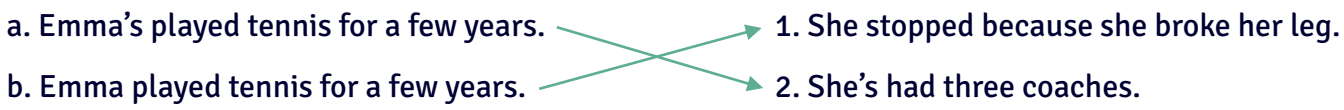
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EXERCISE 5: PRESENT PERFECT AND PAST SIMPLE (TALKING ABOUT EXPERIENCES)

Match the pairs of sentences. Then, choose two pairs and create a few more sentences about each situation.

EXAMPLE:



Emma's played tennis for a few years. She's had three coaches.

She's decided to play tennis professionally. She's won a few championships.

Emma played tennis for a few years. She stopped because she broke her leg.

She spent a few months in hospital. She decided to find a new hobby and started yoga.

A.	a. He's decided to quit his job.	1. He moved to a different city.
	b. He decided to quit his job.	2. He needs to talk to his boss.
B.	a. She's worked here for five years.	1. She's learnt a lot about management.
	b. She worked here for five years.	2. She's had three other jobs since then.
C.	a. Mike finished an SEO course two months ago.	1. He found a new job thanks to it.
	b. Mike's just finished an SEO course.	2. He's looking for a new job now.
D.	a. Eva's eaten a few meat tacos.	1. She was feeling sick the whole evening.
	b. Eva ate a few meat tacos.	2. She's feeling sick now.
E.	a. I've always liked dogs.	1. I have two lovely corgis.
	b. I always liked dogs.	2. Now I prefer cats.
F.	a. They've worked as volunteers since 2020.	1. They love helping people.
	b. They worked as volunteers in 2020.	2. They had a gap year.

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EXERCISE 6: PRESENT PERFECT AND PAST SIMPLE (TALKING ABOUT LIFE STORIES)

You are going to receive some information about you and your partner. Read it carefully. Then, ask your partner questions to complete the information about them. Your partner will answer your questions and ask you for information about you. Finally, find two things you have in common.

EXAMPLE:

Student A:

Your partner has had a dog since _____.

A: *How long have you had a dog? OR When did you get a dog?*

B: *I've had a dog since 2020. OR I got a dog in 2020.*

Student B:

Your partner has had a _____ for two years.

B: *What have you had for two years? OR What did you get two years ago?*

A: *I've had a cat for two years. OR I got a cat two years ago.*

A&B: *We've both had a pet.*

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EXERCISE 7: PRESENT PERFECT AND PAST SIMPLE (TELLING STORIES)

You are going to receive a set of cards from your teacher. Take a card and create a funny question using the picture. Your partner needs to imagine that the situation has really happened, answer the question with '*Yes, I have.*' and continue the story in Past Simple with their ideas. Then, your partner will take a different card and ask you a question. Continue until you've used all the cards.

EXAMPLE:



Have you ever *sat on a cactus?*

Yes, I have. It was on my last vacation in Mexico. We went on a day trip to visit a cacti farm. My brother pushed me and I fell on a cactus. It was just for a second, but it hurt a lot!

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EXERCISE 8: PRESENT PERFECT AND PAST SIMPLE (SHARED EXPERIENCES)

Look at the topics and share something you haven't done but you think your partner has done. If your partner has done it, they need to share three more details about their experience. Then, swap roles.

EXAMPLE: Student A: *I haven't seen [Dune/Barbie/Oppenheimer...] yet.*

Student B: *I've seen it! I went to the cinema last weekend. I went with my friend. I didn't really like it because it was too long.*

- work
- traveling
- films, books, games
- family and friends
- health
- sport
- technology and gadgets
- art
- education and learning
- food and cooking
- fashion
- hobbies and free time
- city
- house

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EXERCISE 9: PRESENT PERFECT AND PAST SIMPLE (TRUTH OR LIE)

Choose one of the activities and say that you have done it. Other students need to ask you three questions about the experience to check if you really have.

EXAMPLE:

Student A: I have won a competition.

Student B: When was it?

Student A: It was at school.

Student B: What was the competition?

Student A: It was a competition to write the best poem.

Student B: What was your poem about?

Student A: It was about my mom.

Student B: It has really happened.

Student A: No, it's a lie! 😉

win a competition

see the ocean

meet a celebrity

watch a whole season of TV series in one sitting

read a book more than once

forget about a work meeting

miss a flight

steal or forget to pay for something by mistake

buy something I didn't need

use a dating app

take a wrong bus

make someone cry

break something expensive that wasn't mine

go abroad alone

wake up in the middle of the day

sing a song on stage

lose a document

stop using social media for a week

give up a bad habit

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